

GS Crypto: What (else) has changed?

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Bitcoin has come off lower from its recent all-time high at \$123,200 and retraced to a low of \$114,800 today (Figure 1). The cross is trading at \$116,500 at the time of writing. Meanwhile Ethereum has continued its rapid ascent and is still hovering within reach of its YTD high of \$3850 (Figure 1). It, however, remains >20% below its all-time-high of \$4865 set in October 2021.

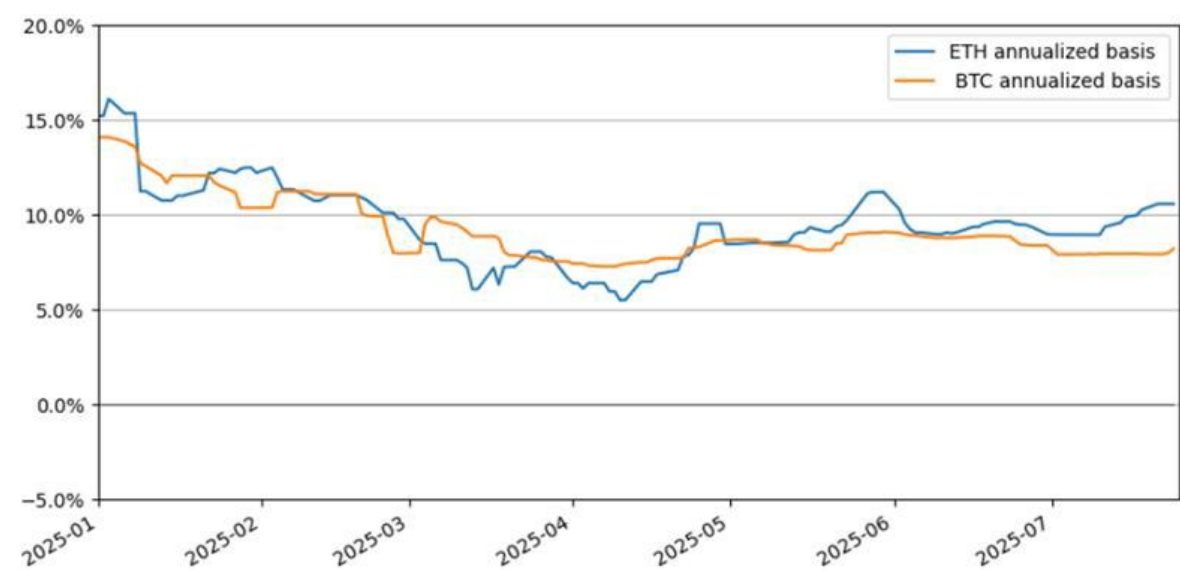
- **Ethereum has moved +50% in July and +150% since April lows** (Figure 1)
Implied volatility remains around 67 across the curve, compared to 45 for Bitcoin (GS Trading)
- **Ethereum CME futures annualised premium to spot has been trading >10%, overtaking that of Bitcoin** (Figure 2). As a result, we have seen rotation of the basis position out of Bitcoin and into Ethereum.
- A newer phenomenon has been several **publicly traded US companies establishing Ethereum reserves**. It is [estimated](#) that such companies bought over \$1.5b of ETH in the last month.

Figure 1. BTC and ETH spot price



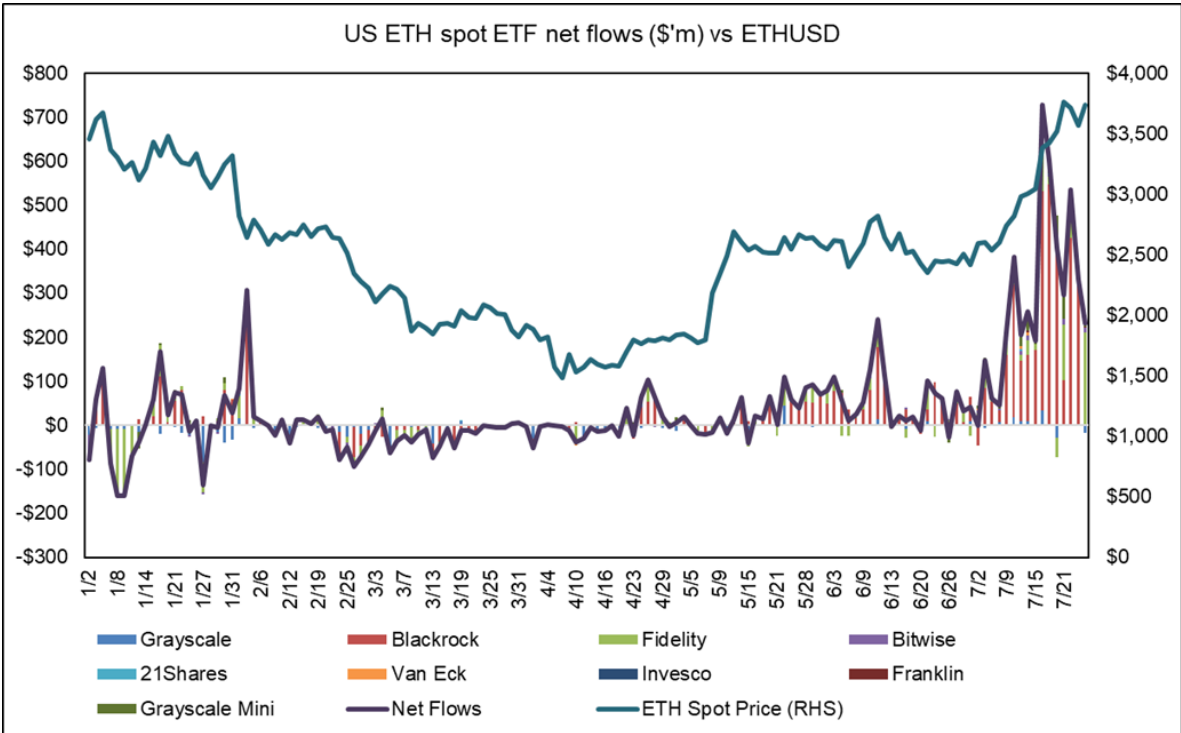
5y history at the bottom of the publication.

Figure 2. Bitcoin and Ethereum annualised spot vs future funding (%)



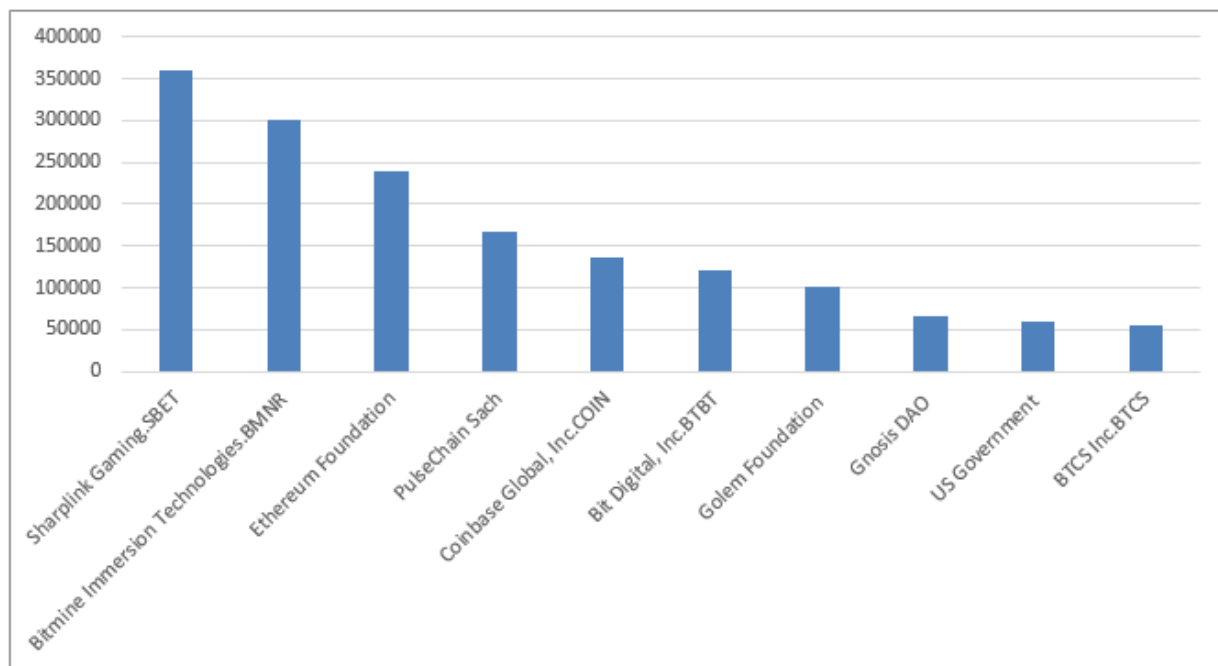
In line with the price action since May, the US ETH spot ETFs have seen a steady stream of inflows (Figure 3). **The US ETH ETFs now hold over \$20b in assets, with net \$6b of inflows YTD (Bloomberg). \$4.8b of those YTD inflows occurred in the last 1-month period.**

Figure 3. Net flows into US ETH Spot ETF



Analogous to [increasing number of corporates allocating Bitcoin exposure to their treasury holdings](#), a newer phenomenon have been several publicly traded US companies [establishing](#) Ethereum reserves. It is [estimated](#) that such companies bought over \$1.5b of ETH in the last month. Top 10 holders of Ethereum (Figure 4, [including the US Government](#)) now account for >1.6m ETH (~\$6b), with some surpassing the holdings of the Ethereum Foundation. This is still a relatively low proportion of the Ethereum free float supply of ~\$400b or of the \$175b of ETH that moved in the past 1 year period (Coinmetrics).

Figure 4. Top 10 ETH holders (ETH units)



Source: GS Sales and Trading as of 25 Jul 2025, past performance is not indicative of future returns

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5y Chart BTC and ETH price



5y history of Bitcoin and Ethereum annualised spot vs future funding (%)

